Figure 6.3 Hierarchical structure of data governance layers

Figure 6.3 presents the general structure of data governance layers. In yellow, a business layer feeds requirements into data governance. This is primarily one-dimensional communication. In green are indicated policies we spoke of earlier. In gold are nonfunctional requirements (*quality attributes*, but we avoid this term so as not to induce confusion with attributes describing the quality of the data itself), prin-ciples, constraints, standards, and conventions. Finally, orange indicates the implemen-tation layer.

In the following section, we describe how the responsibility for each layer can be distributed among parties, depending on the assumed governance structure.

6.3.2 Strategic-level outcomes

Data governance at the strategic level needs to provide links between company strategy and expectations derived from industry standards and internal workings of data operations. The two main tools we propose here are value statements and policies.

You should expect your governance team working at this level to provide the rest of the company with information on the right things to do.

Defining Value Statements

We touched upon the value statement in chapter 3. We explained it’s an assertion of causality between a business action and the resulting business value.

A value statement is an important link between business strategy and business actions. These statements do not translate directly into policies or implementation, but serve as a reference point for them. All business actions are performed in the broader business context (and make no mistake, IT and data operations *are* business actions!). Now, actions bring consequences. The question is, in what light do we evaluate the expected outcomes?